

G-CAF

GovDigital Composable Architecture Framework

Volume 4

Business Drivers & Strategy

v2.0

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Chapter 1

Strategic Traceability

While architecture principles define **WHAT** to do, Business Drivers explain **WHY** — connecting technical decisions to business outcomes.

The Traceability Chain

G-CAF establishes a complete traceability chain from Abu Dhabi's Digital Government Strategy down to individual PBCs:

Level	Content	Question Answered
Digital Government Strategy	Abu Dhabi Strategic Objectives & Pillars	Where are we going?
Strategic Context	Pillars, KPIs, Governance Integration	How do we measure progress?
Business Drivers (BD-001–013)	WHY architectural controls matter	Why do we need this?
Architecture Principles (ARC-001–017)	HOW we achieve driver goals	How do we build it?
G-CAF Contracts, Tiers & PBCs	WHAT we build and govern	What do we deliver?

Value Proposition Alignment

G-CAF Value Proposition	Supporting Drivers
50–70% faster service delivery	BD-002 Speed to Market, BD-008 Vendor Independence, BD-009 Interoperability
30–50% cost reduction	BD-001 Cost Efficiency, BD-008 Vendor Independence
100% governance	BD-003 Citizen Trust, BD-004 Regulatory Compliance
AI-ready	BD-010 Data Quality
Accessible by design	BD-005 Inclusive Service, BD-013 Citizen Experience
Bounded change impact	BD-007 Sustainable Evolution
Operational clarity	BD-006 Operational Resilience, BD-011 Observability

Chapter 2

Strategy Pillars

The Abu Dhabi Digital Government Strategy is organized into eight pillars, each mapped to G-CAF layers and business drivers.

Pillar Overview

Pillar	Strategic Focus	Primary G-CAF Layer
TAMM	Citizen & Business services (G2C, G2B)	Experience Tier
OneHub	Government & Employee services (G2G, G2E)	Experience Tier
Common Digital Platform	Shared capabilities (ERP, ESM, MS365)	Capability Tier: PBCs
Cloud & Infrastructure	ADGOV Cloud, consolidation	Platform Tier: Infrastructure
Cyber & Security	GSOC, compliance, Zero Trust	Cross-cutting: Security Contract
Data & Analytics	GovData, BAYAN, Marketplace	Platform Tier: Data Fabric
Artificial Intelligence	GovAI, Agent PBCs	Capability Tier + Extensions
Operating Model	TMO, CDO Offices, governance	Governance Frame

TAMM Pillar — Example

Strategic Goals: 100% service transactions on TAMM, Customer Effort Score 3.0, Service Quality Index 95%.

Required Driver	Justification
BD-001 Cost Efficiency	Shared PBCs reduce per-service cost
BD-002 Speed to Market	PBC reuse accelerates service deployment
BD-003 Citizen Trust	Foundation for digital service adoption
BD-005 Inclusive Service	Universal accessibility requirements
BD-013 Citizen Experience	Direct alignment with CES target

Chapter 3

Strategy KPIs

Each strategy KPI traces to a business driver and a measurable G-CAF metric, establishing **end-to-end measurability**.

Service Delivery KPIs

Strategy KPI	Target	Business Driver	G-CAF Metric
Customer Effort Score	3.0	BD-013 Citizen UX	PBC UX compliance rate
TAMM Service Quality	95%	BD-006 Resilience	Gateway pass rate
TAMM Transaction Coverage	100%	BD-002 Speed	Service PBC catalog coverage
OneHub Adoption	80%	BD-009 Interop	G2G PBC integration count

Platform KPIs

Strategy KPI	Target	Business Driver	G-CAF Metric
CDP Adoption Rate	80%	BD-001 Cost	PBC Catalog adoption %
Employee Time Saved	500K hrs	BD-002 Speed	Automation PBC coverage
Platform Savings	AED 150M+	BD-001 Cost	Shared PBC cost avoidance

Cloud, Security & Data KPIs

Strategy KPI	Target	Business Driver	G-CAF Metric
Cloud Adoption	100%	BD-002 Speed	Cloud-native PBC %
Data Center Consolidation	55→1	BD-001 Cost	Infrastructure PBC migration
Cybersecurity Maturity	90%	BD-004 Regulatory	Security Contract compliance
Data Barometer Score	90%	BD-010 Data Quality	Data Contract compliance
SSOTs Established	35	BD-010 Data Quality	Reference Data PBC count

AI & Operating Model KPIs

Strategy KPI	Target	Business Driver	G-CAF Metric
AI Use Cases	40+	BD-002 Speed	Analytics + Agent PBCs registered
GovAI Operational	Yes	BD-008 Vendor Indep	AI PBC vendor diversity

Strategy KPI	Target	Business Driver	G-CAF Metric
CDO Offices	80% ADGEs	BD-007 Evolution	Entity capability maturity

Chapter 4

Business Driver Catalog

G-CAF defines 13 business drivers organized into four categories. Each driver explains WHY certain architecture principles exist.

Driver Categories

Category	Drivers
Value Drivers	BD-001 Cost Efficiency, BD-002 Speed to Market, BD-005 Inclusive Service, BD-013 Citizen Experience
Risk Drivers	BD-003 Citizen Trust, BD-004 Regulatory Compliance, BD-006 Operational Resilience
Capability Drivers	BD-007 Sustainable Evolution, BD-008 Vendor Independence, BD-009 Interoperability
Emerging Drivers	BD-010 Data Quality, BD-011 Observability, BD-012 Sustainability

Established Drivers (BD-001 to BD-009)

ID	Driver	Principles Supported	Key Metric
BD-001	Cost Efficiency	ARC-002, ARC-007, ARC-008	PBC reuse ratio > 60%
BD-002	Speed to Market	ARC-001, ARC-002, ARC-008, ARC-009	Time-to-market -50%
BD-003	Citizen Trust	ARC-003, ARC-004, ARC-005	0 critical breaches
BD-004	Regulatory Compliance	ARC-003, ARC-004, ARC-006, ARC-011	100% AE IA compliance 100%
BD-005	Inclusive Service	ARC-006	WCAG 2.1 AA 100%
BD-006	Operational Resilience	ARC-009, ARC-010	99.95% availability (Critical)
BD-007	Sustainable Evolution	ARC-009, ARC-011, ARC-012, ARC-013	Schema evolution compliance
BD-008	Vendor Independence	ARC-001, ARC-007	< 40% single vendor
BD-009	Interoperability	ARC-001, ARC-007, ARC-011	Cross-entity PBC integration

Emerging Drivers (BD-010 to BD-013)

ID	Driver	Recommended Principle	Key Metric
BD-010	Data Quality	ARC-015 Data Quality First	Data Barometer 90%
BD-011	Observability	ARC-016 Observable by Default	Audit log coverage 100%
BD-012	Sustainability	ARC-017 Sustainable by Design	Carbon reduction targets

ID	Driver	Recommended Principle	Key Metric
BD-013	Citizen Experience	ARC-014 Citizen Experience First	CES 3.0

Driver Detail: BD-001 Cost Efficiency

Definition: Maximize value from IT investments by eliminating duplication, optimizing TCO, and enabling efficient resource utilization.

Metric	Target
Cost per transaction	Decrease 20% YoY
PBC reuse ratio	> 60%
Vendor concentration	< 40% single vendor
Cloud waste	< 15% idle resources

Driver Detail: BD-002 Speed to Market

Definition: Deliver new digital services faster, respond rapidly to citizen needs, and enable continuous improvement.

Metric	Target
Time-to-market	50% reduction
Release frequency	Weekly/bi-weekly
Change lead time	< 1 week
PBC assembly time	< 2 weeks

Driver Detail: BD-003 Citizen Trust

Definition: Protect citizen data and maintain public confidence through robust security, privacy, and transparent data handling.

Driver Detail: BD-013 Citizen Experience

Definition: Design services that are intuitive, efficient, and respectful of citizens' time — going beyond accessibility to deliver genuinely excellent UX. Note: Accessible does not equal Usable. Services can be WCAG compliant but still frustrating.

Chapter 5

Driver-Principle Matrix

This matrix shows which business drivers justify which architecture principles, establishing complete traceability.

Well-Supported Principles (3+ Drivers)

Principle	Driver Count	Drivers
ARC-001 API-First	3	BD-002, BD-008, BD-009
ARC-002 Cloud-Native	3	BD-001, BD-002, BD-006
ARC-007 Open Standards	3	BD-001, BD-008, BD-009
ARC-008 Reuse Before Build	3	BD-001, BD-002, BD-007
ARC-009 Loosely Coupled	3	BD-002, BD-006, BD-007
ARC-016 Observable by Default	3	BD-006, BD-011, BD-012

Under-Supported Principles (1 Driver)

Principle	Driver Count	Gap Concern
ARC-005 Zero Trust	1 (BD-003)	Security-only justification; consider BD-004
ARC-012 Tolerant Evolution	1 (BD-007)	Evolvability-only; consider BD-009
ARC-015 Data Quality First	1 (BD-010)	Single driver (acceptable for new principle)

Coverage Summary

Metric	Count
Total Drivers	13
Total Principles Covered	17
Average Principles per Driver	2.5
Principles with 3+ Drivers	6
Principles with 1 Driver	3

Chapter 6

Principle Tensions

Key finding: No contradictions exist. All 13 identified tensions are manageable trade-offs with context-dependent resolution.

High Severity Tensions

ID	Tension	Principles	Resolution Pattern
TEN-001	Reuse vs. Loose Coupling	ARC-008 vs ARC-009	Tier-based: Tier 1 → coupling wins; Tier 3 → reuse wins
TEN-002	Security vs. Tolerant Evolution	ARC-003/005 vs ARC-012	Zone-based: Perimeter → security; Business → flexibility
TEN-006	Data Quality vs. Tolerance	ARC-015 vs ARC-012	Layer-based: Source → quality; Integration → tolerance
TEN-007	Observability vs. Privacy	ARC-016 vs ARC-004	Data-type: PII → privacy wins; Operational → observability
TEN-012	Zero Trust vs. Performance	ARC-005 vs NFR	Boundary-based: External → full verify; Internal → cached
TEN-013	Interface Stability vs. Security	ARC-011 vs ARC-003	Severity-based: Critical CVE → breaking change allowed

Medium Severity Tensions

ID	Tension	Principles	Resolution Pattern
TEN-003	Cloud-Native vs. Legacy	ARC-002 vs ARC-008	Migration-based: TCO analysis
TEN-004	Open Standards vs. Reuse	ARC-007 vs ARC-008	Investment-based
TEN-005	API-First vs. Accessibility	ARC-001 vs ARC-006	Sequencing: Research → API → UI
TEN-008	Sustainability vs. Resilience	ARC-017 vs ARC-010	Tier-based
TEN-010	Citizen UX vs. API-First	ARC-014 vs ARC-001	Inform-then-implement
TEN-011	Citizen UX vs. Reuse	ARC-014 vs ARC-008	Layer separation

Resolution Patterns Summary

Pattern	How It Works	Example
Tier-Based	Winner depends on PBC criticality	Tier 1: Resilience wins; Tier 3: Efficiency wins
Zone-Based	Winner depends on network zone	Perimeter: Security wins; Business: Flexibility wins
Layer-Based	Winner depends on data layer	Source: Quality wins; Integration: Tolerance wins
Data-Type Based	Winner depends on data sensitivity	PII: Privacy wins; Operational: Observability wins

Pattern	How It Works	Example
Severity-Based	Winner depends on security severity	Critical: Security wins; Low: Evolution wins
Sequence-Based	Both apply in ordered sequence	Research first, then implement

Tension Statistics

Category	Count
Total Tensions	13
High Severity	6
Medium Severity	6
Low Severity	1
Involving Existing Principles Only	7
Involving Recommended Principles	6

Chapter 7

Precedence Rules

ARB-approved rules for resolving principle conflicts. These rules must be applied at gateway checkpoints.

Absolute Precedence (Always Win)

Rule	Principle A	vs. Any	Winner	Scope
PREC-ABS-001	ARC-003 Security	Any principle	Security wins	Authentication, authorization
PREC-ABS-002	ARC-004 Privacy	Any principle	Privacy wins	PII handling
PREC-ABS-003	ARC-005 Zero Trust	Any principle	Zero Trust wins	External boundaries

Absolute rules are rare. Most conflicts require conditional resolution based on context.

Conditional: By Criticality Tier

Condition	Principle A	Principle B	Winner	Rationale
Tier 1	ARC-008 Reuse	ARC-009 Loose Coupling	Loose Coupling	Failure isolation paramount
Tier 1	ARC-017 Sustainable	ARC-010 Resilience	Resilience	Availability over efficiency
Tier 3	ARC-008 Reuse	ARC-009 Loose Coupling	Reuse	Cost efficiency acceptable
Tier 3	ARC-017 Sustainable	ARC-010 Resilience	Sustainable	Efficiency over redundancy

Conditional: By Zone/Boundary

Zone	Principle A	Principle B	Winner	Rationale
Perimeter	ARC-003 Security	ARC-012 Tolerance	Security	Strict validation at boundary
Business	ARC-003 Security	ARC-012 Tolerance	Tolerance	Flexibility for payloads
External	ARC-005 Zero Trust	Performance	Zero Trust	Full verification required
Internal	ARC-005 Zero Trust	Performance	Balance	Cached validation acceptable

Conditional: By Data Type

Data Type	Principle A	Principle B	Winner	Rationale
PII	ARC-016 Observable	ARC-004 Privacy	Privacy	Never log PII
Operational	ARC-016 Observable	ARC-004 Privacy	Observable	Full observability OK

Data Type	Principle A	Principle B	Winner	Rationale
Source of Truth	ARC-015 Quality	ARC-012 Tolerance	Quality	Strict at source
Integration	ARC-015 Quality	ARC-012 Tolerance	Tolerance	Tolerant at boundary

Resolution Process

1. **Identify** the tension during design or review
2. **Consult** the specific tension documentation
3. **Apply** precedence rules from this registry
4. **Escalate** to DDA/ARB if no standard resolution applies
5. **Document** the decision in an Architecture Decision Record (ADR)

Chapter 8

Gap Analysis

Analysis of which business drivers lack adequate principle support, leading to recommended new principles.

Identified Gaps

Gap	Driver	Current Coverage	Recommendation	Priority
GAP-001	BD-010 Data Quality	0 principles	ARC-015 Data Quality First	Critical
GAP-002	BD-011 Observability	Agent-only coverage	ARC-016 Observable by Default	High
GAP-003	BD-013 Citizen Experience	Accessibility only	ARC-014 Citizen Experience First	High
GAP-004	BD-012 Sustainability	0 principles	ARC-017 Sustainable by Design	Medium

GAP-001: Data Quality — Critical

G-CAF claims "AI-ready" but no principle ensures data quality. Agent PBCs and Analytics PBCs need reliable data. The Data Asset Catalog exists as governance but not as a design principle.

GAP-002: Observability

The Agent Observability Contract exists but is agent-specific. No general observability principle mandates metrics, logs, and traces for all PBCs. Cross-PBC distributed tracing is not required.

GAP-003: Citizen Experience

ARC-006 Accessibility First (WCAG) exists but "Accessible does not equal Usable." Services can be compliant but frustrating. No principle addresses user research, task completion, or intuitive design.

Chapter 9

Adoption Roadmap

Implementation sequence for adopting the four recommended principles (ARC-014 to ARC-017).

Phased Adoption

Phase	Quarter	Principle	Priority	Rationale
Phase 1	Q1 FY26	ARC-015 Data Quality First	Critical	Foundation for AI; minimal dependencies
Phase 2	Q2 FY26	ARC-016 Observable by Default	High	Builds on Phase 1; platform typically exists
Phase 3	Q3 FY26	ARC-014 Citizen Experience First	High	Requires UX maturity; measurement tooling
Phase 4	Q3 FY26	ARC-017 Sustainable by Design	Medium	Emerging industry practice

Phase 1 Detail: Data Quality First (ARC-015)

Step	Owner	Timeline
Draft principle to ARB	EA Office	Week 1–2
ARB review and approval	ARB	Week 3–4
Update gateway checklists	EA Office	Week 5–6
Training for architects	EA Office	Week 7–8
Pilot with 2–3 PBCs	Pilot Entities	Week 9–12
Full rollout	All Entities	Q2 start

Success Criteria per Phase

Metric	Target
Principle awareness	100% of architects trained
Gateway compliance	> 80% of new PBCs at gateway
Tooling deployed	Quality dashboards for 3+ PBCs
Pilot feedback	Positive from pilot entities